

— EDITION 16

The De-Funding of Cross-Border Monopolies

SWIFT handles \$150 Trillion a year. But its monopoly is facing an existential cross-border squeeze from three sides.

A 6-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 06

The Cracks in the Global Cross-Border Standard.

For decades, international banking has depended entirely on the SWIFT messaging network. But passing text messages across multiple intermediate correspondent banks creates systemic delay and friction.

0202 / 06

Pressure Point 1: Interconnected Real- Time Domestic Rails.

Countries are bypassing traditional correspondent networks entirely by linking their domestic real-time settlement systems (like Brazil's Pix and India's UPI) directly to one another.

0303 / 06

Pressure Point 2: Corporate Stablecoin Corridors.

Global enterprises are increasingly opting out of multi-day wire transfers, routing high-value international liquidity corridors over tokenized public ledgers in seconds for nominal fees.

0404 / 06

Pressure Point 3: AI Orchestration Bypassing Banks.

Autonomous payment routers can dynamically split and route international value across diverse fintech paths, avoiding traditional bottleneck banking hubs entirely.

0505 / 06

SWIFT's Counter-Offensive.

Recognizing the threat, SWIFT is rushing to pilot digital asset sandboxes and real-time ledger connections, trying to morph their messaging protocol into an orchestrator for the modern web.

0606 / 06

The Winner of the New Global Liquidity Superhighway.

The future of cross-border value movement will not be dominated by a single closed consortium, but by open, highly programmable networks that settle transactions at the speed of software.

— THE TAKEAWAY

Found this **useful?**

Repost to share it with your network, and follow for weekly breakdowns of the agentic payments stack.

◆ Joseph Bankole